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AI Scam Safety Checklist

Voice clones, deepfake calls and fake emergencies: a 2-page plan for your family.

The FBI warns that criminals now use AI to copy a loved one's voice from short audio clips and call family members with a fake crisis. You can't always tell a cloned voice by ear, but you can always check. Do the steps below once, and keep page 2 by the phone.

Before: set up your family plan (20 minutes)

- [ ] Pick a family safe word together, in person. Never send it by text or email.
- [ ] Write down real phone numbers for family, your bank and your card issuer, and keep the list by the phone.
- [ ] Agree: anyone can hang up and call back, and no one will be upset.
- [ ] Turn on bank and card alerts, and two-step verification on email and banking.
- [ ] Freeze your credit at Equifax, Experian and TransUnion. It's free and doesn't affect your score.
- [ ] Limit public videos and voice clips of family members on social media.

Red flags: any one means stop and check

- ◯ A loved one in a crisis needs money right now
- ◯ Pay by gift card, wire, crypto, payment app or cash courier
- ◯ "Keep this secret" / "Don't tell anyone"
- ◯ A voice that sounds right on a short, noisy call
- ◯ A boss or bank asking you to move money or change account details
- ◯ Caller ID that looks right. It can be faked.

Sources, checked October 2026: FBI IC3 Public Service Announcement I-120324-PSA (Dec 3, 2024); FTC "Scammers Use Fake Emergencies To Steal Your Money", "What To Do if You Were Scammed", "Refund and Recovery Scams" and "Credit Freezes and Fraud Alerts" (consumer.ftc.gov). General safety information, not legal or financial advice. © 2026 Prompt Sidequest. Free to print and share, unchanged and with credit.

During the call: pause and verify

1. PAUSE
Urgent + money + secret means stop.

2. ASK
"What's our family word?" Don't say it first.

3. HANG UP
Call back on a number you already have.

4. TELL
Call someone else in the family before you send anything.

Ask a question only the real person would know. Can't reach them? Call someone else in the family, even if the caller said to keep it secret.

After: if money or information went out

- [ ] Call your bank, card issuer or payment app right away and ask them to reverse the payment.
- [ ] Gift card: call the number on the back, and keep the card and receipt.
- [ ] Mailed cash: U.S. Postal Inspection Service, 1-877-876-2455.
- [ ] Gave your SSN or a password? Go to IdentityTheft.gov, then change passwords and turn on two-step verification.
- [ ] Report it at ReportFraud.ftc.gov and, for online scams, ic3.gov.
- [ ] Never pay anyone upfront to "recover" your money.

Where to report

ReportFraud.ftc.gov
any scam (FTC)

IdentityTheft.gov
if your information was used

ic3.gov
scams online or by app (FBI)

Your bank or card issuer
number on the back of your card

Want printable safe-word wallet cards, a hang-up-and-call-back script, an account lockdown checklist and fill-in bank and card dispute letters? They're in the **Family AI Scam Safety Kit** at promptsidequest.com.